

□ SOUTH INDIA — CHOLA, CHALUKYA, PALLAVA & SANGAM — FULL MIND MAP

Topic-wise · Fully Explained · Hinglish · SSC / BPSC / BSSC / Railway

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1. Chola Dynasty — Foundation & Extent

- Imperial Chola Empire ki foundation Vijayalaya ne 9th century AD mein (~850 AD) rakhi thi — unhone Muttaraiyar chiefs se Tanjore (Thanjavur) capture kiya aur usse apni capital banaya, early Sangam Cholas ke pathan ke baad ka interregnum khatam karke. [Q1, Q2]
- Chola empire ka core aur expanded region Coromandel coast aur Deccan ke kuch hisso (Uraiyur, Kaveripattinam, Thanjavur) tak phaila hua tha — Tungabhadra aur Krishna rivers tak north mein. [Q5]
- Imperial Cholas ki capital Tanjore (Thanjavur) thi — baad mein Rajendra I ke time Gangaikondacholapuram bhi capital bani. Ancient Sangam era mein Cholas ki capital Uraiyur thi. [Q6]

2. The Brihadeeswara Temple

- Brihadeeswara Temple (Thanjavur), Chola emperor Rajaraja-I ke reign mein bana — Dravidian style architecture ka excellent example hai, isse 'Rajarajeshvaram' bhi kehte hain. [Q4]
- Is temple ke exterior mein ek gigantic 'Nandi' (ek hi rock se carved) hai — India ka sabse ooncha Nandi idol maana jaata hai (halaki Lepakshi ka Nandi bhi bahut bada hai aur kai jagah largest monolithic maana jaata hai, PCS exams mein generally Brihadeeswara Nandi ko hi answer maana jaata hai). [Q3]

3. Chola Village Administration

- Chola administration ki special/unique feature thi village administration ki autonomy (local self-government) — ye bahut systematic aur well-developed thi, central command se independently function karti thi. [Q7, Q10, Q11, Q12, Q13]

- Chola age apni elaborate village assemblies (Gram Sabhas jaise Ur aur Sabha) ke liye sabse famous tha. [Q8, Q9]
- Chola village administration ki working system ki detailed jaankari 'Uttaramerur' inscription se milti hai — isme bataya gaya hai ki har village ki apni 'Sabha' committee hoti thi, jo Central command se independent hoke village administer karti thi. [Q14]
- Chola villages mein 'Variyam' naam ke working committees hote the jo alag-alag kaam dekhte the: 'Thotta Variyam' — Horticulture/garden board dekhta tha; 'Samvatsara Variyam' — annual committee thi; 'Eri Variyam' — tanks/water supply dekhti thi; 'Pon Variyam' — gold/finance se related thi. [Q15]
- Chola administrative-land terms: 'Eripatti' — wo land jiska revenue village tank (talab) ke maintenance ke liye rakha jaata tha. 'Ghatikas' — temples se attached colleges/learning centres hote the. ('Taniyurs' bade villages hote the jo separate unit ki tarah administer hote the, Brahmins ko donate NAHI kiye jaate the — Brahmadeya/Agrahara alag concept tha.) [Q34]

4. Chola Bronze Art — Nataraja & Iconography

- Chola period ke Nataraja (dancing Shiva) bronze icons hamesha 4 haath ke saath dikhaye jaate hain — Chola artists (Sthapati) stone se zyada bronze sculptures banane mein mahir the. Nataraja ki idols duniya ki behtareen sculptures mein se maani jaati hain. [Q17, Q18, Q19, Q20]
- 'Dakshinamurti' idol mein Shiva ko Guru/Teacher (mentor) roop mein dikhaya jaata hai — wo apne devotees ko ultimate gyan aur cosmic wisdom dete hain, aur ye idol generally south direction ki taraf face karti hui installed hoti hai. [Q21]
- Nataraja statue mein Shiva ko 4-haath ke saath dancing pose mein dikhaya jaata hai, jo unke creator-preserver-destroyer teeno roop ko ek image mein combine karta hai. Unke right ear mein mard ki earring (Makarakundala) aur left mein aurat ki earring (Tatanka) hoti hai, jo male-female principles ke union (Ardhanarishwara concept) ko symbolize karta hai. [Q22]

5. Chola Trade, Guilds & Foreign Missions

- Chola king Kulottunga-I ke reign mein (1077 AD), ek goodwill mission mein 72 traders China bheje gaye the. [Q23]
- 'Nanadesis' aur 'Manigrama' ancient South India ke traders ke guilds the, jo Hoysala/Chola period mein sabse badi trading associations mein se the — inke foreign countries ke saath bhi significant trade contacts the. 'Manigramam' ek merchants ki corporation thi jo South Indian townships mein trade-business badhane ke liye kaam karti thi. [Q35, Q66]

6. Chola Naval Power & Overseas Conquests

- Chola kings ke paas massive troops aur proficient naval power wing tha — Chola navy ne empire ke expansion mein vital role play kiya, Ceylon (Sri Lanka) ki conquest aur Srivijaya/Sinhala jaise jagaho par naval raids ke through. [Q24]

- Chola Dynasty ki sthapna Vijayalaya ne ki, lekin Parantaka-I ne isse solidify kiya — unhone Madura (Pandya) ke raja ko haraakar 'Madurai-Konda' ki title li. Rajaraja-I aur unke bete Rajendra-I ne South East Asia ke Sailendra empire (Srivijaya) ke against naval expeditions bheji thi. [Q16]
- Rajendra Chola-I (Rajaraja-I ke bete) ne apni dominant naval campaigns (Srivijaya Empire ke against bhi) se Bay of Bengal ko practically ek 'Chola Lake' bana diya tha. [Q26]
- Rajendra-I ne Bengal ke Pala king Mahipala ko haraya — Ganges tak ki apni victorious campaign celebrate karne ke liye unhone 'Gangaikonda' (Ganga ke conqueror) ki title li, aur ek nayi capital 'Gangaikonda Cholapuram' banayi. [Q27]
- Apni nayi capital Gangaikonda Cholapuram ke liye paani ka intezaam karne ke liye, Rajendra Chola I ne ek bada artificial lake banwaya jise 'Chola Gangam' kehte hain. [Q28]
- Rajaraja-I ke gaddi par baithne (985 AD) se Chola empire ka golden era shuru hua — wo pehle Chola king the jinhone ek formidable Naval Army banayi, jisse Sri Lanka aur Maldives jaisi overseas territories conquer ki gayi. [Q29]
- Rajaraja-I ne Sri Lanka par invade karke uski capital Anuradhapura destroy ki — unhone sirf Sri Lanka ka northern hissa capture kiya, southern hissa independent raha. Baad mein unke bete Rajendra-I ne southern hissa bhi capture karke poore Ceylon ko Chola control mein le liya. [Q30, Q31]
- Ceylon ke king Vijayabahu ne Kulottunga-I ke period mein Sinhala Island ki independence declare kar di thi — lekin Kulottunga ne koi hostility nahi dikhayi, ulta apni beti ki shaadi Sinhala prince Virapperumal se karwa di, Sri Lanka ko complete azaadi de di. [Q32]

7. Chola Succession Practice & Historical Sources

- Chola emperors generally apne hi tenure mein apna successor ('Yuvraj'/crown prince) elect kar dete the, jo unke baad empire ka heir banta tha — isse succession ki wajah se hone wali ladaiyan ruk jaati thi. [Q25]
- Assertion-Reason: Cholas ke baare mein humein unke predecessors se zyada jaankari hai (sahi), kyunki Rajaraja-I aur Rajendra-I ne temples ki deewaron par inscriptions likhwaye — Rajaraja-I ne apne ancestors ki jeeto ki kahaniyan likhne-collect karne ki tradition shuru ki (sahi Reason bhi, jo Assertion ko explain karta hai). [Q33]

8. Battle of Takkolam & the Decline of the Cholas

- Famous 'Battle of Takkolam' Rajaditya (Chola king Parantaka-I ke bete) aur Rashtrakuta King Krishna-III ki confederacy ke beech lada gaya tha — Chola aur Rashtrakutas ke beech ka ye important conflict tha. [Q67]
- ⚠ Disputed: Chola dynasty ka final devastation kisne kiya iska ek clear jawab nahi hai — ~1250 AD mein Hoysala aur Pandya kingdoms ne Chola King Rajendra III ko haraya, aur dynasty ~1279 AD tak khatam ho gayi. Malik Kafur ne ~1310 AD mein South India conquer ki thi (Yadavas, Hoysalas, Kakatiyas, Pandyas), lekin Chola empire uske aane se pehle hi decline ho chuki thi. [Q68]

9. The Chalukya Dynasty

- Pulakesin-II (610-642 AD) Chalukya dynasty ke sabse capable aur powerful ruler the — unke court poet Ravikirti dwara likha 'Aihole Inscription' unki achievements ki gatha batata hai, jisme Harshavardhana par unki jeet bhi shaamil hai. [Q37]
- Chalukya administration mein women ko high-ranking positions di jaati thi — jaise Vijaya Bhattarika (Chandraditya ki Queen, Vikramaditya-I ke bhai) ne apne naam se copper plates issue kiye aur administration efficiently chalaya. Vikramaditya ne apni chhoti behen Kumkumdevi ki recommendation par ek Brahmin scholar ko village grant di. [Q38]
- Early Chalukyas ki capital Vatapi (aaj ka Badami, Bagalkot dist., Karnataka) thi — 6th-7th centuries mein. [Q39]
- Aihole Inscription (Pulakesin-II ke baare mein, Ravikirti ne Sanskrit + southern Brahmi script mein likha) mein poet Kalidasa ka naam mila hai — Ravikirti ne khud ki fame Kalidasa aur Bharavi jaisi bataayi thi. [Q40, Q41]
- Chinese traveller Matwalin ne Chalukya reign ke dauran China-India relationship ka account diya tha. [Q82]
- Chalukya dynasty ne North India par kabhi raj NAHI kiya — unka rule mainly Deccan aur South India tak centralized tha, capital Badami (Vatapi) thi. North India par Mauryas, Guptas aur Rajput clans ka raj tha. [Q83]
- Chalukya (Solanki) King Kumarapala (Gujarat), Jainism se bahut influenced the aur Jain scholar Hemachandra ke shishya ban gaye the — Jain traditions ke mutabik unhone Kashi region mein janwaro ke against cruelty rokne ke liye apna minister bheja tha. [Q84]

10. The Pallava Dynasty

- Pallava king Narasimha Varman I (630-668 AD, 'Mahamalla'/great wrestler bhi kehlaate the) ne 642 AD mein Ceylon (Sri Lanka) ke liye 2 naval expeditions bheji thi (ek Sri Lankan prince ki madad ke liye). Unke time famous Panch Ratha Temples bane, aur unhone Chalukya capital Vatapi ko capture-destroy karke 'Vatapikonda' ki title li. [Q42]
- Capital-Dynasty match: Badami → Chalukyas (Pulakesin-II unke glorious king the); Kanchipuram → Pallavas ki capital; Kannauj → Harsha aur unki behen Rajyashri ne saath mein raj kiya; Madurai → Pandyas ki capital. [Q77]
- Historical events ka chronological order: (2) Mahendravarman-I ne Pallava Power establish ki (600-630 AD) → (4) Gopala ne Pala dynasty banayi (750 AD) → (1) Mihirabhoja/Bhoja I, Gurjara Pratihara dynasty ke powerful ruler bane (836-885 AD) → (3) Parantaka-I ne significant Chola power establish ki (907-953 AD). [Q78]
- Pallava rulers ka chronological order: Mahendravarman I (600-630 AD) → Narsinghvarman I (630-668 AD) → Parmeshvaravarman I (~670-700 AD) → Nandivarman II (731-795 AD). [Q81]

11. The Chera Dynasty

- Udiyanjiral, Chera dynasty se belong karte the — Chera empire modern Kerala mein located thi. Wo Sangam period ke pehle historical king the — legends ke mutabik unhone Mahabharata war ke sabhi fighters ko ek feast di thi. [Q70]

- Pairs check: South India ke states (6th-12th century) aur unki capitals — sab pairs sahi hain except Chera-Puducheri (galat) — Chera ki actual capital Vanchi (ya Karur) thi, Puducheri nahi. [Q79]
- Chera dynasty ki capital Karur/Karuvur thi (inland capital) — kuch sources ke mutabik unki coastal capital Thondi bhi thi. Chera ka doosra prominent naam 'Vanchi' bhi tha. [Q80]

12. The Pandya Dynasty

- Vengi (Vaigai) river Pandya state ki lifeline thi — ye river Madurai ke pass Kandan Manikanur mein originate hoti hai. Pandya state Kaveri river ke south mein situated tha. [Q71]
- ~26 BC mein, ek South Indian Pandya raja ne Rome ke Augustus ke darbar mein ek ambassador bheja tha, trade-diplomacy badhane ke liye — Pandya dynasty ka South India mein sabse lamba reign duration raha, unki capital Madurai thi. [Q87]
- Famous Meenakshi Mandir, Madurai (Tamil Nadu) mein situated hai — Madurai, Pandyas ki capital thi. Sangam era mein yahi 1st aur 3rd Sangam conventions organize hui thi (Acharya Agastya aur Nakkirar ki presidency mein). [Q89, Q90]

13. Other South Indian Dynasties — Kadamba & Kakatiya

- Kadamba rulers ki capital Vanavasi (Banavasi, aaj ke Karnataka mein) thi — is dynasty ki sthapna Mayurasharman ne ki thi, baad mein Chalukya king Pulakesin-II ne unke state ko annex kar liya. (Tanjore Cholas ki, Kanchi Pallavas ki, aur Badami Chalukyas ki capital thi.) [Q85]
- Motupalli (aaj ke Andhra Pradesh mein), Kakatiya kingdom ka ek bahut important seaport tha — Venetian traveller Marco Polo isi port se hoke Kakatiya kingdom gaye the aur Andhra Desh ki prosperity-trade ke baare mein tareef mein likha. [Q86]

14. Sangam Literature — Tolkappiyam, Kural & the Twin Epics

- 'Tolkappiyam', 2nd Sangam era ki residual text hai aur Tamil literature ka sabse purana available text hai — grammar aur poetry (poetics) par ek comprehensive treatise hai. Author Tolkappiyar, Sage Agastya ke 12 disciples mein se ek the. Ye 3 parts (Ezhuttu-letter, Col-word, Porul-subject matter) mein bata hua hai, har part 9 sections ka hai. [Q45, Q46, Q47]
- Great Tamil epic 'Silappadikaram' ke author Ilango Adigal the — Chola King Karikal ke pote maane jaate hain. Isme Kannagi aur unke pati Kovalan ki tragic love story hai. [Q48]
- Match: Thirukural → Philosophy (ethics ka manual); Tolkappiyam → Grammar; Silappadikaram → Love Story (Kannagi-Kovalan); Manimekalai → Merchant story (Silappadikaram ka sequel). [Q49]
- Sangam literature South India ki sabse purani available Tamil literature hai — Sangam poets ko Varna ka social classification pata tha (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Vellalars/Sudras ka zikr milta hai). Sangam poems mein heroism, martial valor aur warrior ethic ko celebrate kiya jaata hai, aur nature ki magical forces ka bhi zikr hai. [Q52]
- 'Kural' (Tirukkural) Tamil bhasha mein compose hui — ise Tamil literature ka 'Bible' aur 'Laghuvada' maana jaata hai. Isse 'Muppal' bhi kehte hain, aur famous Tamil poet-philosopher Tiruvalluvar ne likha. [Q60, Q61]

- Tamil Ramayanam (Ramavataram) ke author Kamban the — unhone ye Chola period mein likhi thi. [Q63]

15. Sangam Assemblies & Sage Agastya

- 'Sangam' ka matlab hai 'Poets ki Conference' ya 'Scholars ka Forum' — 3 Sangams Pandya kings ke patronage mein hui. 1st Sangam: Madurai (Sage Agastya ne preside kiya). 2nd Sangam: Kapadapuram (Agastya, baad mein Tolkappiyar ne preside kiya). 3rd Sangam: Madurai (Nakkirar ne preside kiya). [Q75]
- Sage Agastya ko South India ko 'Aryanised' karne ka credit diya jaata hai — mana jaata hai ki Gods ke request par wo south gaye aur wahi reh gaye. Unhe 'Father of Tamil Literature' bhi kaha jaata hai, unhone pehle Sangam ki presidency ki thi. [Q76]

16. Sangam-Era Ports, Trade Centres & Roman Contact

- Tagara (aaj ka Ter, Maharashtra) Kalyan (western coast) aur Vengi (eastern coast) ko jodne wale ancient trade route par ek significant trade centre tha. [Q36]
- 'Yavanapriya' ancient Sanskrit texts mein Pepper (kaali mirch) ke liye use hone wala term tha — Indian black pepper Roman cooking mein bahut favourite ingredient thi, isliye ise 'Yavanapriya' (Greeks/Yavanas ka favourite) kaha jaata tha. [Q43]
- Arikamedu (Pondicherry ke pass, south-eastern coast) se Roman Empire ke saath trade relations ke evidence mile hain — Augustus Caesar ki tasveer wala ek intaglio, Roman beads/gems/Amphora jars mile hain. Dubreuil ne Arikamedu ko 'a true Roman city' kaha tha. Ye Eastern India ka sabse bada Indo-Roman trading station tha. [Q53, Q54]
- 'The Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' ke anonymous Greek author ne Arikamedu port ko 'Poduke' naam se refer kiya tha. Yahin Roman settlement/trading post ke archaeological evidence mile hain. [Q55, Q56]
- 'Amphora Jar' ek lambi patli gardan wala jar hota tha, dono taraf handles ke saath — ancient Rome-Greece mein wine/oil transport-storage ke liye use hota tha. Aise kai jars Arikamedu mein mile hain, Roman trade ka proof. [Q57]
- Uraiyur (Cauvery river ke kinare, Tiruchirappalli) Sangam era mein cotton trade ka bahut important centre tha — ise Koli aur Varanam bhi kehte the, 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' mein bhi iska zikr hai. [Q69]
- Sangam ports western coast (Chera kingdom) par: Naura, Tondi, Mushiri (Muziris), Nelisanda. Eastern coast ke prominent ports: Korkai (Pandyan) aur Puhar/Poompuhar (Kaveripattinam - Chola). [Q72, Q73]
- Roman Empire ke saath maritime trade South India mein mainly Chera Kingdom se shuru hui — Roman objects, coins, pottery Muziris (Chera territory) aur Arikamedu (Puducherry) mein mile hain. [Q88]

17. Sangam-Era Kingdoms & Society

- Sangam Literature mein Chola, Chera aur Pandya — 3 major Southern kingdoms ki origin/rise ka vistarpoorvak zikr hai. Kadamba dynasty (ya inke alawa koi bhi dynasty) classical Sangam literature mein ek ruling power ki tarah mention NAHI hai. [Q58]

- Sangam Age (Tamil country) mein Chera, Chola aur Pandya — teeno major ruling dynasties thi. Pallavas bahut baad mein ek badi power ban kar ubhare, wo early Sangam age ke rulers NAHI the. [Q59]
- 'Vattakirutal' ek ancient Tamil martial practice thi — jung mein haare hue raja dwara khud ko bhookha rakhkar (fasting unto death) ritual suicide karna, Sangam period mein prevalent thi. [Q62]
- Sangam texts ke mutabik 'Kon', 'Ko' aur 'Mannan' — teeno titles King (raja) ke liye use hote the. [Q74]

18. Bhakti Saints — Alvars, Nayanars, Siddhas & Lingayats

- Shaivite saints ki writings ka collection 'Fifth Veda' maana jaata hai, jiska naam 'Thirumurai' hai — ye 12-volume compendium hai, Shiva ki tareef mein hymns, 6th se 11th century CE tak ke. Ye Vedas aur Saiva Agamas ke saath Saiva Siddhanta philosophy ka aadhar banata hai. [Q50]
- Tradition ke mutabik total 12 Alvars (Vishnu ke devotees) aur 63 Nayanars (Shiva ke devotees) hain — dono South India ki Bhakti tradition ke saint-poets ke groups hain. [Q51]
- Siddhas Sangam period se trace hote hain — wo refined monotheistic the aur idolatry (murti pooja) ki ninda karte the. Kannada region ke Lingayats ne Brahmins ke caste-based superiority ko challenge kiya, rebirth ke theory ko question kiya, aur widow-remarriage ko encourage kiya. [Q64]

19. Miscellaneous — Language, Architecture & Match Lists

- Halbi ek Eastern Indo-Aryan language hai (Aryan language family), jo Chhattisgarh ke Bastar region mein boli jaati hai — Oriya aur Marathi ke beech ek transitional language ki tarah kaam karti hai, Oriya aur Devanagari scripts mein likhi jaati hai. [Q44]
- Match: Gupta → Deogarh (Dashavatara Temple); Chandela → Khajuraho (famous temple complex); Chalukya → Badami (unki capital); Pallava → Panamalai (Talagirisvara temple). [Q65]
- South India ke temples ke mighty gateways ko 'Gopurams' kehte hain — Dravidian style Pandyas aur Cholas ke time flourish hui. Pandya period mein temples chhote the lekin unke courtyard ke around bahut ramparts banaye gaye the. [Q92]
- Match: Meenakshi Mandir → Madurai (Tamil Nadu); Venkateswara Mandir → Tirumala (Andhra Pradesh); Mahakal Mandir → Ujjain (Madhya Pradesh); Belur Matha → Howrah (West Bengal — Ramakrishna Mission ka headquarters, Swami Vivekananda ne banaya). [Q91]